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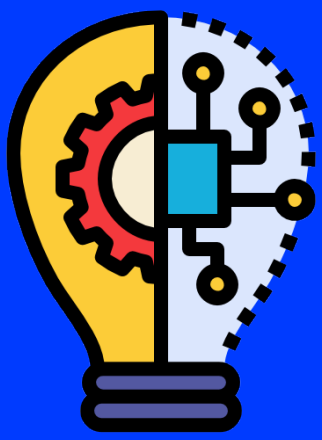
INNOVATION TRACK_

< HIGHWAY TO TECH4 />



INNOVATION TRACK

Let’s build together your action plan for the rest of your Epitech Innovative Project. It will accompany you through your Tech4 to reach your goal.

Your action plan must take the form of a written document containing 3 parts:

1. Context
2. Technical specifications
3. Non technical specifications

Your goal with this action plan is to descrive everything you plan to do with your project on technicals and non technicals aspects.

🚀 This document will have to be submitted on the EIP plateform.

Context

This first part is the easier one, you just have to remind the context and overall goal of your project. Someone external to the project must broadly comprehend what the project is about just be reading this part.

Answers questions such as ”Where does this project comes from?”, ”If it's a solution, what is the identified problem? And what is the solution”, ”What is the goal of the project ?”, ”What inside tracks did you choose for your project?”

If you work with external entities or people (like a partner or someone external with a special skillset), mention it in this part too.

Technical Specifications

The second part is considerably harder and will probably need multiple iterations (talk with your pedagogical team!)

In this part you must mention the technological stack you intend to use (hopefully the prototype part helped you to choose it) then describe **EVERYTHING** we will be able to do with your project.

To do so, a good way is to use user stories (but feel free to use another form if this one is not adapted to your project).

> It it of the most importance that your descriptions are **precise**, not to allow misinterpretation. This part will be used throughout the lifecycle of your project.
> It will be useful for you to keep track of what you implemented and what's still ahead af you.
> It will be useful for your pedagogical team in charge of monitoring the progress of the project and giving you guidelines.

In this part you can also add timed milestones to help you have a plan and objectives on where to go with your project during your 4th year.

> You may define as many milestones as you fancy, but we advice you to define 3 to 5 of them.
> For each of them, define one or several objectives, such as “build a POC that...”, “refine the UX/UI to fit users feedbacks”, “release those 3 features”,... that should be done to consider that a milestones has been correctly reached.

Non-Technical Specifications

This third, and last, part is where you have to define the non-technical aspects of your project. **You will be supported in these aspects by your mentor during your internship, so you don't have to do it right now.**

Mentors

Mentors are experts that have significant experience in the track you choose (entrepreneurship, solution, technical). They have been chosen for their ability to inspire and support you towards success.

Mentors have the opportunity to select specifically the projects they follow, to maximise their engagement and guaranty full support for your ambitions. Their only aspiration is to make the most out of your project and accompany you to reach your main goal.

> Mentors will monitor your project, your progress, your ambitions mainly based on your document, even if they are not limited to this tool. .

You will interact with them through:

1. **Video meetings**:
   Meetings with mentors will take place at regular intervals.
2. **Asynchronous support**:
   Mentors are also available by chat to answer your daily questions and help you move forward on your project.

Topics

Your non-technical specifications come in the form of topics that you want to explore for your project (some are mandatory, some are optionnals). These topics depend on your choosen ”inside track”.
Your document must mention each of the mandatory topics and at least two of the optionals one from your track. For each one, write a note of intent on what you want to develop from this topic specifically for your project and what your goals are.

For instance, for the `"Develop and retain a user community"` topic, describes the steps you intend to do to develop a community.

Solution

Mandatory

1. Develop and retain a user community
   - ✓ Build a base of early adopters
   - ✓ Organize test and feedback sessions to fine-tune the product
2. Work on use experience
   - ✓ Identify and improve less fluid user interface functionalities.
   - ✓ Optimize product design.

Optional (choose at least 2 of them)

1. Increase visibility and impact on social networks
   - ✓ Implement a targeted communication strategy.
   - ✓ Create engaging content adapted to each social network.
2. Establish strategic partnerships
   - ✓ Collaborate with private companies, public players or associations, depending on project needs.
   - ✓ Set up joint initiatives with your partners to increase the project's impact.
3. Optimize relationships with the target audience
   - ✓ Implement mechanisms to better understand end-users.
   - ✓ Inform and share project improvements and developments with end-users on a regular basis.
4. Enhance credibility and grow the project's reputation
   - ✓ Participate in events and conferences.
   - ✓ Publish demonstrations and case studies to reinforce the project's impact.

Technical

Mandatory

1. Evaluate and integrate new technologies (technical monitoring)
   - ✓ Benchmark emerging technologies.
   - ✓ Test and integrate those that add the most value to the project.

Optional (choose at least 2 of them)

1. Protect and enhance your technology
   - ✓ Use appropriate open source licenses, patents or copyrights.
   - ✓ Get expert advice on best practices for protecting technological innovations.
2. Develop community contributions
   - ✓ Create contexts that facilitate external contributions.

- ✓ Organize challenges to engage other developers.

3. Collaborate with technical experts
   - ✓ Identify and solicit technical experts of your field to give feedbacks on your project.
   - ✓ Participate in specialized discussion groups and forums.

Entrepreneurship

Mandatory

1. Validate the idea using market validation techniques
   - ✓ Use market validation techniques to adjust the initial idea.
   - ✓ Perform rapid iterations to adapt to market feedback.
2. Master entrepreneurial tools
   - ✓ Develop a solid, realistic business model.
   - ✓ Carry out SWOT analyses, develop pitch decks and analyze the competition.

Optional (choose at least 2 of them)

1. Establish fruitful partnerships
   - ✓ Collaborate with relevant private, public or associative players.
   - ✓ Leverage these partnerships to accelerate project growth.
2. Define a strategy and vision
   - ✓ Target the most promising market segments (B2B, B2C).
   - ✓ Develop a strategic roadmap to achieve long-term objectives.
3. Enhance the project's image and message
   - ✓ Develop a strong, consistent brand.
   - ✓ Refine pitch and discourse to maximize impact with customers.
4. Plan for growth and expansion
   - ✓ Develop strategies for expansion.
   - ✓ Identify growth opportunities and untapped markets.

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